

Martin Søyland

POSTDOCTORAL FELLOW, UNIVERSITY OF STAVANGER

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Experience

Postdoctoral Fellow

University of Stavanger

DEPARTMENT OF MEDIA AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

10.2026-present

Three-year position as Postdoctoral Fellow, affiliated with the national research infrastructure KODEM. Research focus on legislative studies, political elites, and computational social science. One year dedicated to establishing and developing the Norwegian Politician Panel (Norsk politikerpanel), one of the four panels in KODEM. Survey design, and contact with elected representatives and institutions across Norway. Teaching according to the department's needs.

Researcher

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

10.2022-12.2022 and 11.2025-09.2026

Research position in the *Tilstandsanalyse av det norske demokratiet* (TiNDe) project. Work included linking conceptualization to data sources, data gathering, data structuring, data management, and contributions to the final report. The second period largely consist of data gathering for round two of the project, including fielding an expert survey, and academic article production based on the project.

Senior Advisor

Riksantikvaren, Oslo

THE DIRECTORATE FOR CULTURAL HERITAGE

08.2025-03.2026

30% temporary position as senior advisor. Responsible for collecting, structuring, and reporting on large scale data on cultural heritage in Norway. Additionally, developed surveys of cultural heritage owners and initiated a project with the Norwegian Space Agency for tracking wear and tear on heritage sites and buildings.

Associate Professor

University of Stavanger

DEPARTMENT OF MEDIA AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

08.2025-12.2025

60% temporary replacement position. Course convenor for Comparative Politics (BST250) and Quantitative Methods (BST290) course on the BA level.

Postdoctoral Fellow

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

05.2021-08.2025

Open position as Postdoctoral Fellow with 25% teaching. Research focus on methodological developments in computational social science, legislative studies, and organized political actors. Mainly using Norway as case, but also the United Nations General Assembly, House of Commons, and more. Development of R packages on Norwegian politics and Norwegian language. Teaching and development of courses at the BA and MA level, including R teaching. Supervision of MA and doctoral students.

Researcher

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

01.2021-05.2021

20% project position at *Tilstandsanalyse av det norske demokratiet* (TiNDe). Work included contributions to grant proposal, project planning, conceptual development, gathering data, preparing data, and data facilitation.

PhD Candidate

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

01.2016-05.2020

Open position as doctoral student with 25% teaching. My thesis utilized quantitative text analysis methods on parliamentary speeches in the Norwegian Storting and how one can analyze political behavior based on these. Teaching and course development on both BA and MA level, in a variety of courses. Supervision of MA thesis. Defended the thesis in November 2020.

Developer

University of Oslo

SOCIAL SCIENCE DATA LAB

09.2019-12.2019

Development of digital workbooks and other tools for methods teaching at the University of Oslo. Foundation work for BA methods tutorial for R.

Research assistant

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

06.2015-12.2015

100% position as research assistant with various teaching and research projects.

Teacher / TA

Bore skule

PRIMARY SCHOOL (GRADES 1 - 7)

2007-2008

First a 100% position through the civilian service program in Norway, where I helped teachers in the classroom, and provided support to students with special needs. After that, I was a substitute teacher during my studies in Stavanger.

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

01.2016-05.2020

- Thesis: *Parliamentary Debates in Norway: A Computational Social Science Approach*
- Trial lecture: *How do intra-party relations in multiparty systems affect the functioning of parliaments?*
- Supervisor: Professor Bjørn Høyland
- Defense discussants: Professor Royce Carroll and Doctor Iulia Cioroianu
- Visiting at Harvard University (fall of 2016), w/ Prof. Daniel M. Smith

Master's in Political Science

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

08.2013-06.2015

- Thesis: *Survival of the Ministers: On Ministerial Durability in Postwar Norway*
- Supervisors: Professor Bjørn Høyland and Doctor Cristina Bucur
- Defense discussants: Professor Bjørn Erik Rasch and Professor José Antonio Cheibub

Bachelor's in Political Science

University of Oslo

DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

08.2010-06.2013

- Thesis: *Secrecy and Governance: On the correlation between secrecy jurisdiction status and quality of governance*
- Minor in English

One Year Foundation Programme in History

University of Stavanger

08.2009-06.2010

Publications

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Bjørkholt S. and Søyland M. (2024)

THE DRAMA IS IN THE INK: CONFLICT IN WRITTEN PARLIAMENTARY QUESTIONS

Legislative Studies Quarterly 50 (1): 123-129

Finseraas H., Høyland B., and Søyland M. (2021)

CLIMATE POLITICS IN HARD TIMES: HOW LOCAL ECONOMIC SHOCKS INFLUENCE MPs ATTENTION TO CLIMATE CHANGE

European Journal of Political Research 60 (3): 738-747

Høyland B. and Søyland M. (2019)

ELECTORAL REFORM AND PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

Legislative Studies Quarterly 44 (4): 593-615

Langsæther P. E., Gjerløw H., and Søyland M. (2019)

IS ALL PR GOOD PR? HOW THE CONTENT OF MEDIA EXPOSURE AFFECTS CANDIDATE POPULARITY

Electoral studies 57: 143-152

Lapponi E., Søyland M., Velldal E., Oepen S. (2018)

THE TALK OF NORWAY: A RICHLY ANNOTATED CORPUS OF THE NORWEGIAN PARLIAMENT, 1998-2016

Language Resources and Evaluation 52 (3): 873-893

Røed, M. and Søyland, M. (Forthcoming)

LEGISLATORS' CONSTITUENCY FOCUS ACROSS ELECTORAL SYSTEMS

Legislative Studies Quarterly (accepted 25 Sept 2026)

Søyland M. (2017)

SURVIVAL OF THE MINISTERS: ON MINISTERIAL DURABILITY IN POSTWAR NORWAY

Scandinavian Political Studies 40 (2): 182-206

Søyland M. (2015)

TILBAKEHOLDEN OG EKSPANSIV LIBERALISME: OM UTENRIKSPOLITIKK I STATE OF THE UNION-TALER

Internasjonal politikk 73 (1): 7-27

BOOKS

Thorsen, D. E., Jøsok, E. and Søyland, M. (2026)

FOKUS: POLITIKK OG MENNESKERETTIGHETER

Aschehoug. ISBN: 9788203414732

Nedregård O., Søyland M. (2025)

LEGISLATIVE PARTY GROUPS AND PARTY COHESION

In Allern E, Braut-Hegghammer M, Kolltveit K, Rasch BE (eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Norwegian Politics*. Oxford University Press

Søyland M., Høyland B. (2021)

NORWAY: COMMITTEE-MEMBERSHIP MATTERS PARTY LOYALTY DECIDES

In Bäck, H., Debus, M., and Fernandes, J. M. (eds.) *The Politics of Legislative Debates*. Oxford University Press

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Søyland M. (2022)

PARTY CONTROL AND RESPONSIVENESS: HOW MPs USE VARIATION IN LOWER-LEVEL INSTITUTIONAL DESIGN AS AN ELECTORAL RESPONSIVENESS MECHANISM.

CEUR Workshop Proceedings 3133: 101-117

REPORTS

Knutsen C. H., Dahlum S., Allern E. H., Hagfors S. B., Klausen J. E., Søyland M., and Wig T. (2023)

TILSTANDSANALYSE AV DET NORSKE DEMOKRATIET

Universitetet i Oslo. [Link](#)

Ongoing Research

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Functions of Nonlegislative Activities: Conceptualization and Measurement

BJØRKHOLT, S. AND SØYLAND, M.

Status: Submitting in 2026.

Previously presented at: NOPSA (2024), PODS (ISV, UiO, 2024), and Gothenburg University (2024)

Patterns of Global Politics: Geopolitical Entity Networks in the UN General Assembly

DJUVE, V. L AND SØYLAND, M.

Status: Submitting in 2026.

Previously presented at: APSA (2024), CIR (ISV, UiO, 2023), National Conference in Political Science (2024), and University of Stavanger (2024)

The Political Origins of Critical Social Science

HJORT, F., WIG, T., BALTZERSEN, E., AND SØYLAND, M.

Status: Submitting in 2026.

Previously presented at: EPSA (2025), Lund University (2025), and University of Oslo (2025)

Far from perfect? A template for measuring regime developments in very democratic countries

KNUTSEN, C. H., DAHLUM, S., ALLERN, E., KLAUSEN, J. E., SØYLAND, M. AND WIG, T.

Status: Submitting 2026.

Previously presented at: EPSA (2025), National Conference in Political Science (2026), and University of Oslo (2026)

Hard Choices in Hard Times: Norwegians' attitudes & trade-offs in the Green Transition

KNOTZ, C., CONILL, R. F., SJØVAAG, H., SØYLAND, M. AND THESEN, G.

Status: Survey was fielded in Spring 2026

All eyes on m(e)inisters: democratization and media accountability

KRISTIANSEN, INA L., SØYLAND, M. AND THESEN, G.

Status: Under revision

Previously presented at: WhoGov Mini-Conference on political elites (2026)

Trade Union Appeals in Legislative Debates

RØED, M. AND SØYLAND, M.

Status: R&R at *European Journal of Political Research*.

Previously presented at: EPSA (2024) and National Conference in Political Science (2025)

Gendered Communication in Parliamentary Questions

RØED, M., SØYLAND, M., AND BÄCK, H.

Status: Under review at APSR

Previously presented at: National Conference in Political Science (2025) and EPSA (2025)

Enhancing Data Reusability: A Proposal and an Assessment

SØYLAND, M.

Status: Minor R&R at *PS: Political Science & Politics*.

Previously presented at: National Conference in Political Science (2025), Tuesday seminar series (ISV, UiO, 2023), DH-forum (UiO Library, 2022)

Cross-Partisan Co-Sponsoring in Parliamentary Systems

SØYLAND, M. AND THÜRK, M.

Status: Revising and submitting during 2026.

Previously presented at: EPSA (2025) and ECPR Standing Group on Parliaments Conference (2025), University of Gothenburg (2025), and the Comparative Institutions and Regimes, University of Oslo (2025)

Funded Projects

Trade Union Appeals

Småforsk, UiO

MEMBER

2025

'Småforsk' project with Maiken Røed on when MPs use such positive and negative appeals to trade unions between 1950 and 2019.

The project sheds new light on whose interests MPs seek to represent.

Parliamentary Questions in the Storting

Småforsk, UiO

LEADER

2023-2025

'Småforsk' project with Solveig Bjørkholt. This project focuses on analysis of written parliamentary questions in the Norwegian parliaments from 1998 to the present. The goal of the project is twofold: 1) contribute to the literature on quantitative text analysis on political texts, especially for Norwegian language, and 2) theoretical and empirical contributions to the literature on behavior in parliaments.

Tilstandsanalyse av det norske demokratiet (TiNDe)

UiO

MEMBER

2021-2027

TiNDe, led by Carl Henrik Knutsen and Siranne Dahlum, aims at developing nuanced and rich measures of different aspects of democracies, that can be used to capture differences in level and changes among high quality democracies. Norway as case.

Doctoral project with Emanuele Laponi, Stephan Oepen and Erik Velldal. The project gathered and preprocessed speeches in the Storting from 1998 to 2016. The data also comes with state of the art grammatical tagging of the texts via the Oslo-Bergen-tagger (OBT).

Teaching

LECTURES AND SEMINARS

Course (w/ links)	Level	Years	Role	Lectures and tasks
University of Stavanger				
Comparative politics	BA	2025	Course convenor	11 lectures covering the breadth of comparative politics
Quantitative methods	BA	2025	Course convenor	5 lectures and 10 PC-lab seminars in quantitative methods for social science students
University of Oslo				
Quantitative text analysis	MA	2017–2018	Course convenor	4 lectures in preprocessing and modeling of text data
Big text data (Norwegian)	BA	2022–2024	Course convenor	10 lectures in text-as-data approaches
Comparative politics	BA	2018–2025	Lecturer	Lectures on the effects of regime types, elections and electoral systems, and legislatures and governments
Norwegian politics (Norwegian)	BA	2024–2025	Lecturer	Lecture on the Storting and Norwegian government
Social Science Data Analysis and Programming	BA	2025	Lecturer	3 lectures on webscraping of APIs and static websites
The Politics of Organized Political Actors	MA	2025	Lecturer	2 lectures on the legislative and government arena, and the role of parties within these
Introduction to political science	BA	2015	Seminar leader	Writing and discussion training seminars for first year BA students
Research methods and statistics	BA	2015–2022	Seminar leader R	Development of R-seminars in intro to methods and statistics
International political economy	BA	2016	Seminar leader	Course assignment seminar with presentations and discussions
Democratic Institutional Design	BA	2015	Seminar leader	Course assignment seminar with presentations and discussions
BA thesis in political science	BA	2021–2022	Seminar leader	Discussion seminars for BA thesis drafts
Research methods and statistics	MA	2016	Seminar leader R	Development of R-seminars in intro to methods and statistics for MA students
Statistical Analysis	MA	2017	Seminar leader R	Development of R-seminars in advanced methods and statistics
Digital Data in Political Science	MA	2023	Course development	Shared responsibility for development of course material, videos, and digital book
Design seminar in political science	MA	2021–2022	Seminar leader	Discussion seminars of first outline draft of MA thesis

SUPERVISION

Candidate	Level	Year	Title
Bjørkholt, Solveig	PhD	2023–2025	<i>Refining or Ruling: The Politics of International Standardization</i>
Baltzersen, Eli S.	PhD	2023–2025	<i>State action, public attitudes, and sexual consent</i>
Hauge, Elin T.	PhD	2025–	<i>Intelligence warning on political protest in autocracies</i>
Baccouche, Elias K. B. T.	MA	2022	<i>Fra klassisk til global jihad: En revurdering av tilbakeslagsteorien med Tjenestekontorets «al-Jihad Magazine» som case</i>
Coelho, Indira	MA	2026	<i>Countering InfOps in the cyberspace: can algorithms aid in identifying harmful meta-narratives in political discourse?</i>
Fjell, Amalie	MA	2024	<i>Endringer i fødetilbudet i Norge</i>
Frydenlund, Jan	MA	2023	<i>Media trust and affective political polarization: Does distance disparage trust?</i>
Gunadasan, Birgitha Syse	MA	2025	<i>On the Path from Colony to Tax Haven</i>
Knudsen, Sara G.	MA	2023	<i>Questioning Accountability: A Survival Analysis of Ministerial Durability Through Parliamentary Accountability Measures</i>
Marchand, Oda	MA	2020	<i>Informasjonskrig i det 21. århundret: En studie av prorussiske og antinvestlige narrativ i postsovjetiske stater, med vekt på Moldova</i>
McConnell, Thea Virginia	MA	2026	<i>Russian disinformation and Norwegian media outlets</i>
Nygaard, Nora Johanne	MA	2024	<i>En analyse av debatten rundt kontantstøtten</i>
Rotabakk, Olga	MA	2025	<i>Befolkningsutvikling i Norge: Demografiske endringer og lokalpolitiske prioriteringer</i>
Smørdal, Martine Aamås	MA	2021	<i>Politiske partier, kjønn og preferanser i familiepolitikken: Hvordan kvinners politiske representasjon kan påvirke partiers preferanser</i>
Williamson, Caroline	MA	2021	<i>Kartlegging av partiers preferanser til utvidelse av arbeidstrygdordninger</i>

EXAMINATION

Course	Institution	Year	Description
Introduksjon til komparativ politikk	UiS	2026	Grading written exams
Komparativ politikk	UiS	2025	Grading written exams
Kvantitativ metode	UiS	2025	Grading term papers
Makt og politikk	UiS	2025	Grading written exams
Disputation Nina Maureen Cadorin	UiO	2024	Evaluation Committee (internal)
Research Methodology and Statistics	UiA	2024	Grading of written exams
Big Text Data	UiO	2022–2025	Grading written assignments and holding oral exams
Master's thesis in Political Science	UiO	2018–2024	Grading 30 credits Master's theses, including oral exam
Innføring i statsvitenskap	UiO	2018	Grading written exams
Metode og statistikk	UiO	2016	Grading written exams

Media and Presentations

2026	Eliteprivilegier og ansvarsflukt. Samtale med Carl Henrik Knutsen , Folkeakademiet Time	Panel
2026	Det gjenstår å se om et lobbyregister faktisk kommer på plass , Altinget	Op-ed, w/ M. Røed
2026	Demokratitilstanden i Norge - er det grunn til bekymring? , Barne- og familiedepartementet	Invited presentation
2025	Bistand og Ukraina blant taperne hvis Stortinget ikke vedtar budsjettet i tide , Panorama nyheter	Interview
2025	Demokrati under press. Samtale med Ingrid Fiskaa , Folkeakademiet Time	Panel
2025	Ble valget påvirket av kunstig intelligens? , dScience, UiO	Panel
2025	Partilederdebatten fra Arendal minutt for minutt , Aftenposten	Live commentator
2025	Partilederdebutt i Arendal , Aftenposten	Live commentator
2025	Ulstein om støtte til Listhaug: – KrFs budskap har vært klokkeklart , Vårt Land	Interview
2025	Et steg til høyre? , ABC Nyheter	Op-ed
2025	Også vi må være på vakt , Klassekampen	Op-ed, w/ V. L. Djuve
2025	Derfor mener ekspertene KrF gjør lurt i å posisjonere seg , ABC Nyheter	Interview
2025	Flere stemmer - en møteplass for demokratiet vårt , SoCentral, Norsk PEN (26-05-2025)	Panel

2025	Spør Ekko: Regjeringskabal , NRK P2 (05-02-2025)	Radio show
2025	Regjerings-exit for dummies , Aftenposten	Interview
2024	Erna Solberg kom oftere til Stortinget enn Jonas Gahr Støre , NRK	Interview
2024	Breakfast Seminar: Artificial Intelligence in Social Science Research , Læringsnettverket EILIN	Invited presentation
2023	Hvor demokratisk er det norske demokratiet? , Verdens Gang	Op-ed
2023	Ung i IT – Meetup , Dataforeningen, UiO	Invited presentation
2023	Skandale etter skandale etter skandale , Morgenbladet	Interview
2023	Freista og forført , Stavanger Aftenblad	Narrative essay
2023	Hvor ble det av ryggraden? , Dag og Tid	Op-ed
2022	Forskere fikk meldeplikt, men alle kildene var døde , University of Oslo	Interview
2022	DH-forum: R and accessing the Norwegian parliamentary data , University of Oslo	Invited presentation
2022	Statsvitenskapelige analyser av store datamengder , University of Oslo, HON1000	Invited presentation
2021	VGTV: Nye meningsmålinger , Verdens Gang	TV show
2021	Plagsomt med demokrati , Jærbladet	Op-ed
2019	Erna Solberg ga Stortinget feilaktige flyktningtall , Aftenposten	Interview
2019	Politikere bør holde seg til å snakke om politikk, viser ny forskning , forskning.no	Dissemination
2017	Bestemmer seg først når budsjettet er landa , NRK	Interview
2017	Ikke representativt , Vårt Land	Interview
2016	Personstemmer går på bekostning av politikk , Aftenposten	Op-ed
2013	Bondestudent , Jærbladet	Narrative essay

Courses

Quantitative Causal Analysis and Prediction

University of Oslo

PHD COURSE

2016

- Doctoral course in causal inference.
- Lecturers: T. Wig, B. Høyland, H. Finseraas og A. Kotsadam.

EITM Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis

University of Mannheim

PHD COURSE

2016

- Doctoral course in quantitative text analysis.
- Lecturers: J. Lo, S. Fang, A. Spirling og N. Baerg

Comparative Political Institutions

Harvard University

PHD COURSE

2016

- Doctoral course on political institutions.
- Lecturer: D. M. Smith

Summer School on Parliaments

Humboldt-Universität

PHD COURSE

2017

- Doctoral course in theoretical and empirical research on parliaments.
- Lecturers: S. Bailer, L. Wängnerud, T. Leeper, F. Zucchini, K. Strøm, T. Saalfeld, S. Martin, B. Høyland og H. Klüver

Institutional Responsibilities

2026	Committee member , Hiring committee, PhD positions in AutoKnow, Dept. of Political Science	University of Oslo
2022-2023	Leader , FAU (Parents' Working Committee)	Margarinfabrikken barnehage, Oslo
2018-2019	PhD representative , Programme council for the PhD programme, Faculty of Social Sciences	University of Oslo
2018-2019	Deputy member , Political Science Department Board	University of Oslo

Reviews

Journal of Politics, peer review
Legislative Studies Quarterly, peer review
European Journal of Political Research, peer review
Scandinavian Political Studies, peer review
European Educational Research Journal, peer review
Politics, peer review
Electoral Studies, peer review
Å studere statsvitenskap (S. Dahlum et.al), book consultant
R for alle (T. Hegghammer), book consultant

Development

stortingscrape	CRAN
R PACKAGE	2025
Automated data gathering from the Storting API. Close to 9000 installations from CRAN.	
TiNDe-explorer	shiny.uio.no
SHINY DASHBOARD	2023
Shiny app for TiNDe indices.	
noRc	Github
R PACKAGE	2023
Tools for roll call analysis in Stortinget.	
NorSentLex	Github
R PACKAGE	2022
Sentiment dictionary for Norwegian in R.	
Talk of Norway	Github
R PACKAGE	2018
Data on speeches in the Storting.	
ministersNor	Github
R PACKAGE	2016
Data on Norwegian cabinet members (1945-2013).	

Awards & Fellowships

2021-2025 Postdoctoral fellowship , Department of political science	University of Oslo
2016-2020 PhD fellowship , Department of political science	University of Oslo
2014 Ordingprisen , for best student paper in the Nordic countries	Internasjonal Politikk

Leave of absence

Parental leave , from 2020 (May) to 2021 (May). Extended because of the covid pandemic. 80% leave and 20% position on the TiNDe project from 01.21 to 05.21.	2020-2021
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References

Bjørn Høyland

Professor

UNIVERSITY OF OSLO, DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

bjorn.hoyland@stv.uio.no

Relation: Bjørn was my supervisor during my PhD and Master's, and mentor during my postdoctoral fellowship. I have also co-authored several papers and a book chapter with Bjørn.

Phone number: Given on request

Maria Thürk

Assistant Professor

UPPSALA UNIVERSITY, DEPARTMENT OF GOVERNMENT

maria.thurk@statsvet.uu.se

Relation: Maria and I are currently co-authoring a paper. Maria was also the student contact and guide during my stay at Humboldt-Universität (*Summer School on Parliaments*).

Phone number: +46 72 234 37 58

Carl Henrik Knutsen

Professor

UNIVERSITY OF OSLO, DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

c.h.knutsen@stv.uio.no

Relation: Carl Henrik is the co-leader of the TiNDe project, which I have participated on over several periods. He has also helped me in extending my outreach and with improving my teaching.

Phone number: +47 90 95 57 08